

DAVIDE DANTONIO

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Innovation Economy operator who sources, vets, coaches, and structures capital for the best and most diverse pre-Seed and Seed founders, all in one role. 5+ years of related experience; sole director of 10 accelerator cohorts across the United States and Europe.

Work Authorization: United States, Europe, United Kingdom · Open to relocation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

GENER8TOR, Venture Capital Firm & Startup Accelerator

Indianapolis, IN

Director of Accelerator Programs (SaaS, AI, Industry 4.0, AgBioScience, Aerospace)

January 2023 to Present

- Provided tailored strategic advice and executional guidance to 50+ portfolio startups in both individual strategy sessions and cohort-based trainings: customer discovery for problem-solution fit, sales discovery and repeatable go-to-market for product-market fit, and fundraising to scale a proven business model. Wins include rScan (Startup of the Year, TechPoint 2025 Mira Awards; \$1.2M Indiana state tax credits, 152 jobs), Guama (Colombia; \$1.5M seed, 6,000+ customers, rivaling Bancolombia and BBVA), Arophia (\$1M seed, founder to Forbes Cleveland 30 Under 30), Novac (Italy; €3.5M, all four founders to Forbes Italia Under 30), and Covert Defense (Department of Homeland Security contract plus \$1M+ non-dilutive National Science Foundation funding). Collectively, they raised \$7.84M (\$5.43M dilutive, \$2.42M non-dilutive), created 220 jobs, and earned a top-tier 86 founder NPS (Y Combinator ~60, Techstars ~40).
- Sourced more than 600 pre-Seed and Seed founders and university innovators across 10 cohorts (9 Indiana, 1 European), vetting each through due diligence on unit economics, cash burn, customer concentration, business viability, technical feasibility, founder strength, and market opportunity to select the top 5 per cohort; doubled applications and exceeded program targets by 150%.
- Launched gener8tor's first European-funded cohort (gBETA Skyward Italy: Aerospace & Advanced Manufacturing), commissioned by the Italian Region of Emilia-Romagna and co-funded by the European Union; advised 8 Italian startups on US fundraising and market entry, redesigned the curriculum for later-stage founders, and saw four go on to operate in the United States.
- Built a network of 250+ investors, 300+ mentors, and 20+ Entrepreneurial Support Organizations via in-person activations, University Tech Transfer Offices, LinkedIn Sales Navigator, and partnerships with the Indiana Economic Development Corporation, delivering 60+ curated introductions per founder, including those that brought Vertikal X's US headquarters to Indianapolis.

AMAZON PAY, Payment-Gateway Service

Luxembourg

Account Management Intern, FR/IT/ES region

February 2021 to July 2021

- Managed a 20+ client E-Commerce portfolio, tailoring credit and payments solutions for C-level executives across Finance and IT; exceeded sales targets by 140% as top second-quarter performer, drove \$1.3M in incremental transaction volume across 26 launches, and prevented \$2.5M in projected revenue loss through 7 client WinBacks.

KRAFT HEINZ COMPANY

Amsterdam, Netherlands

Procurement Intern, Ingredients Team (EMEA region)

August 2020 to January 2021

- Identified \$200K in savings and negotiated 40+ supplier contracts (requests for proposals and e-auctions) and cut contract review time by 50%, working with 150+ suppliers.

MAMMA FLORA, Made-in-Italy E-Commerce

London, United Kingdom (remote)

Marketing & Business Development Intern

May 2020 to July 2020

- Cut website bounce rate below 50% with a 4-day user-experience rebuild (Shopify to Squarespace) and grew qualified leads 15% in one month; closed 5 European distribution partnerships worth \$50K.

ENTREPRENEURSHIP, ADVISORY & COMMUNITY

- Gave back to the venture ecosystem by judging 8 startup competitions, presenting 15+ founder workshops, and mentoring across 15+ organizations: Entrepreneurial Support Organizations (Village Capital), university venture arms (Purdue Research Foundation), federal programs (National Science Foundation I-Corps, Akron and Purdue), and state initiatives (STARTedUP Foundation).
- Vice-President of Platform, Born Global (2025): led the Founders' Roundtable and Venture Lab advisory.
- Founder, Young Outcasts Podcast (2024): interviewed 10+ guests across 20+ hours on resilience and reinvention.
- Operations Coordinator, BX Group growth-hacking agency (2022 to 2023): built a cross-sell strategy preempting 5,000 alerts.
- Advisory Council, McNair Institute, University of South Carolina (2022 to 2023): mentored 100+ student founders.
- Founder, EarOnAir wellbeing platform (2022): led a peer team to a minimum-viable product.
- Founder, LushTech micro-mobility startup (2020): secured a \$25K seed via incubation programs.
- Growth Analyst, Build It Up student consulting (2020): shipped a CO₂-offset plugin used by 800+ users.
- Earlier: Teaching Associate, UIBE Business School (2019); Project Coordinator, Euronatale trade-show operations (2017 to 2018).

EDUCATION

- University of South Carolina, Moore School of Business: Master of International Business (full-tuition merit scholarship; GPA 3.9/4.0; STEM Certificate in Analytics), 2019 to 2022.
- ESCP Business School (Madrid & London): Master in Management, dual degree with Universidad Carlos III de Madrid. Bocconi University (Milan): Bachelor's in Business Administration, GPA 3.7/4.0.

SKILLS

Venture finance & risk diligence: financial modeling, valuation (comparables, discounted cash flow), cash-flow scenarios, capital structuring (dilutive and non-dilutive), market sizing, and risk evaluation (operational, reputational, execution).

Sales & Business Development: Salesforce, HubSpot, LinkedIn Sales Navigator, Apollo, Clay; structured sales-qualification methods (MEDDPIC, SPIN); multi-channel inbound and outbound funnels; Ideal Client Profile definition and mutual-connection strategy.

Languages: Italian (C2 native), English (C2), Spanish (B1), German (A2).